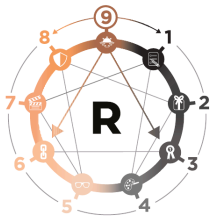
TYPE

9

THE PEACEMAKER

The Mediator



The Calm Presence Who Makes Every Client Feel at Home

CORE MOTIVATION IN THE SALON

> Type Nines are driven by a desire for peace, harmony, and connection. They avoid conflict, merge with others' energy, and have a gift for making everyone feel comfortable and included. In the salon, Nines create an environment where clients genuinely exhale — the chair becomes a sanctuary.

CLIENT COMMUNICATION STYLE

- Nines are warm, easy-going, and deeply receptive listeners. Clients feel completely heard and unhurried.
- They may over-agree in consultation — saying 'yes' to avoid conflict even when they have reservations.
- **Natural strength:** The salon appointment with a Nine feels restorative. Clients leave calmer than when they came in.
- **Growth edge:** Sharing their expert opinion — even when it differs from the client's. The Nine's perspective has value.

THE CONSULTATION

- Nines are patient, thorough listeners in consultations — they give clients space to fully express what they want.
- They can under-direct — waiting for the client to decide rather than offering a clear professional recommendation.
- **Tip:** Practice offering a confident opinion after gathering information: 'Based on what you've told me, here's what I think would work beautifully for you.'

CREATIVITY & ARTISTRY

- Nines have a natural, understated aesthetic sense. Their work tends to be harmonious, balanced, and deeply flattering.
- They may resist bold or divisive looks — preferring what will universally please.
- Their creative strength is enhancing natural beauty in a way that feels effortless and right.
- **Growth edge:** Developing and sharing a bolder creative voice.

SELF-WORTH MASTERY: MOVING FROM FIXED TO GROWTH

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I don't want to disrupt things by asking for more — a price increase, a better schedule, a leadership role.' → What would you tell a colleague who was afraid to ask for what they deserved? Say that to yourself right now. Then identify one thing you have been afraid to ask for and make the ask this week.

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I've been deferring my own advancement because it feels selfish — there's always something more important.' → Your development is not a disruption to the

people you care about. It is the thing that allows you to keep showing up for them. Name one career goal you've been postponing. What is the first concrete step?

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I'm not sure what I actually want — I'm so used to going along with what others need.' → Spend five minutes journaling this prompt: If no one else's preferences mattered, what would my ideal workday look like? What services would I do? What clients would I see? What would I charge? Let that vision inform one real decision this week.
- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'My presence, opinions, and preferences don't matter as much as everyone else's.' → In your next team meeting or client consultation, offer your genuine opinion before anyone else speaks. One sentence. Your perspective has genuine value — and the world needs to hear it.
- **Your growth affirmation:** My presence matters. My opinion has value. My needs are not a disruption — they are important. I show up fully, and the world is better for it.

BUILDING YOUR BUSINESS BEHIND THE CHAIR

- Nines build businesses best through their extraordinary client experience — and by learning to claim credit for it intentionally.
- Ask for reviews, testimonials, and referrals. Nines may resist this because it feels self-promoting — but inviting others to share their experience is simply making the invisible visible. You have earned these endorsements. Claim them.
- Set a price increase schedule and stick to it annually. Nines often avoid this because it feels disruptive. Reframe: it is a maintenance of your professional integrity, not an imposition on your clients.
- Develop a specialty that is distinctly yours. Nines can blend so well into clients' needs that they never build their own reputation. A specialty creates a gravitational pull that builds a brand over time.
- Create structures that take career development off the table as optional. Pre-schedule advanced trainings, put business goals in writing, and review them quarterly. Nines who build external accountability move faster than those who rely on internal motivation alone.
- **Social media:** Post your work consistently, even when it feels uncomfortable. Your work is beautiful — the world deserves to see it. Even one post per week creates compounding visibility over time.

SELLING SERVICES & RETAIL

- Nines can struggle with retail because selling feels like imposing — they don't want to make anyone uncomfortable.
- They are most effective when they can weave retail into natural conversation: 'Oh, speaking of your hair feeling dry — I've been wanting to tell you about this...'
- **Reframe:** Recommending is sharing. It's an offering, not a demand. You can recommend and let the client decide — that's completely safe.
- Nines who relax into the conversation find that retail happens naturally — because clients are comfortable and open.
- Nines build natural rapport that makes retail conversations feel easy and unforced.
- The key is making the habit of mentioning one product per appointment — every time, without fail.

- **Watch for:** Forgetting to recommend at all because the conversation got comfortable. Build in a trigger — perhaps at the shampoo bowl or at checkout.

FEEDBACK, BOUNDARIES & TOUGH CONVERSATIONS WITH CLIENTS

- Nines receive feedback best when it is delivered gently, with genuine care for their wellbeing. Harsh feedback causes a Nine to shut down or disconnect rather than integrate.
- **The deeper challenge with feedback:** Nines can hear it, nod, agree — and then return to exactly what they were doing before. Processing feedback requires the Nine to actually stay present in the discomfort rather than diffusing it into pleasantness.
- **With unhappy clients:** Nines' natural response is to soothe and accommodate. This is valuable — but watch for agreeing to redo work that didn't actually need redoing, just to end the discomfort.
- **Setting limits with clients:** Nines struggle most with limits because saying no feels like the end of harmony. Practice: 'I hear you, and I want to take care of you — here's what I'm able to do.' Offering what you CAN do keeps the harmony intact while maintaining your boundary.
- **Giving feedback to clients:** Nines may resist sharing professional observations that feel critical — even when the client genuinely needs to hear them. Practice: 'I want to share something that I think will really help...' Leading with care opens the door without conflict.
- **Tough conversations:** Nines avoid them — sometimes for months, sometimes for years, sometimes until the situation becomes a crisis. Practice: the longer you wait, the heavier it gets. A five-minute honest conversation now prevents a five-hour crisis later.

TEAM DYNAMICS, FEEDBACK & UTILIZING YOUR GIFTS ON A SALON TEAM

- On a salon team, Nines are the peace-keepers and the connectors. They smooth over conflicts, create an atmosphere of welcome, and make every team member feel included and valued.
- They are extraordinary at reading the emotional temperature of the team and calibrating accordingly — often diffusing tension before others have even noticed it.
- **Natural team contribution:** Team harmony, inclusive culture, client experience, conflict mediation, and the grounding presence that allows everyone else to bring their full energy without burning out.
- **Growth edge:** Speaking up when they see a problem rather than absorbing it. Nines who hold all the awareness and none of the voice create invisible imbalance on the team.
- **Watch for:** Merging with the salon's dominant culture to the point of losing their own perspective. A Nine who always agrees with the most forceful voice in the room provides no counterbalance to that voice.
- **Power move:** In a team meeting, offer your genuine opinion before anyone else has spoken. This practice — one honest, unprompted perspective per meeting — changes how you are seen and experienced on the team.
- Nines thrive in salon cultures that are warm, collaborative, and consistent. They disengage in environments with chronic conflict, unaddressed tension, or volatile leadership.

CAREER PATH ALIGNMENT

- Master Stylist with a deeply loyal long-term clientele — the relationship is the career
- Salon Manager or Culture Builder — creating harmony and a positive team environment
- Educator or Mentor — the calm, patient teacher who makes everyone feel capable
- Spa or Holistic Services — environments that honor the healing power of touch and presence

STRESS & GROWTH PATHS

UNDER STRESS

Under stress (moving toward Type 6), Nines become anxious, worried, and vigilant — losing their peaceful quality entirely. They may catastrophize and seek reassurance excessively.

IN GROWTH

In growth (moving toward Type 3), Nines become more decisive and goal-oriented. They show up with more energy, build their clientele with intention, and realize their presence has genuine value.

WINGS

Every type is influenced by one of its neighboring types — called a wing. While your core type remains primary, your wing adds flavor and nuance to how you show up in the salon.

9w8 — The Referee

The 8 wing adds quiet assertiveness and backbone to the Nine's gentle nature. These stylists are easy- going AND clear — they don't push, but they also don't get pushed around.

- **Client Style:** Calm, grounded, and quietly confident. Clients feel utterly at ease AND trust the expertise.
- **Selling Style:** Relaxed and direct when needed. Can advocate for a product recommendation without feeling like a salesperson.
- **Challenge:** May oscillate between too passive and suddenly too firm. Developing a consistent middle ground of gentle assertiveness.

9w1 — The Dreamer

The 1 wing adds idealism, ethics, and a quiet perfectionism. These stylists are peaceful AND principled — they care deeply about doing things right and creating experiences that are genuinely good.

- **Client Style:** Calm, precise, and trustworthy. Clients feel they are in principled, steady, caring hands.
- **Selling Style:** Recommends thoughtfully and only when genuinely needed. Clients trust their integrity completely.
- **Challenge:** Can become self-critical under pressure — the Nine's avoidance combined with the One's inner critic can create internal paralysis around imperfection.

YOUR GENIUS: A COSMETOLOGIST SUMMARY

GENIUS INSIGHT

Type Nines carry one of the most undervalued gifts in the cosmetology profession: the ability to create genuine peace. In a culture that rarely stops — that moves at the speed of social media, trend cycles, and packed appointment books — the Nine's capacity to slow down, truly see their client, and make the salon chair feel like the safest place in the world is not a soft skill. It is a clinical gift. The Nine's growth invitation is to show up as fully present as possible — not just for their clients, but for themselves. To claim their opinions, their preferences, and their deserved success as parts of who they are, not impositions on the people they serve. When a Nine stops disappearing and starts showing up — when they speak, lead, charge, and commit — they discover something extraordinary: their presence was never too much. It was exactly what the world was waiting for.